

at 11–13 (majority opinion); *id.*, at 35–40 (Rutledge, J., dissenting). Because Madison and Jefferson played such leading roles in the events leading to the adoption of the First Amendment, the *Everson* opinions did not hesitate to reproduce the partial text of their Virginia bill as a primary source for understanding the objectives, and protections, afforded by the more concise phrasing of the Establishment Clause. *Everson*, *supra*, at 12–13, 28; see *Reynolds*, *supra*, at 163–164. Extracts from that bill also bear repeating in the present context. The preamble provided, in part:

“[T]o compel a man to furnish contributions of money for the propagation of opinions which he disbelieves, is sinful and tyrannical; that even the forcing him to support this or that teacher of his own religious persuasion, is depriving him of the comfortable liberty of giving his contributions to the particular pastor, whose morals he would make his pattern.” 12 Hening’s Stat. 85.

Its operative language emphatically stated:

“That no man shall be compelled to frequent or support any religious worship, place, or ministry whatsoever, nor shall be enforced, restrained, molested, or burthened in his body or goods, nor shall otherwise suffer on account of his religious opinions or belief . . .” *Id.*, at 86.¹⁴

Justice Rutledge summed up Madison’s views in the following terms:

“In no phase was he more unrelentingly absolute than in opposing state support or aid by taxation. Not even ‘three pence’ contribution was thus to be exacted from

¹⁴ Although the bill is in some sense merely the pronouncement of a small legislative body, its proscription was intended to transcend temporal bounds. The enactment concludes:

“And though we well know that this Assembly, enacted by the people for the ordinary purposes of legislation only, have no power to restrain the